

The Screw That Turned: How Two Brothers Fastened India's Industrial Independence

In India's quest for manufacturing prowess, the most profound revolutions often happen in the most overlooked corners.

While India's industrial landscape buzzed with software exports and pharmaceutical breakthroughs in the late 1990s, two brothers in Ghaziabad were plotting a different kind of disruption. Their target wasn't algorithms or molecules—it was the mundane world of screws and fasteners, an industry so invisible that most entrepreneurs wouldn't give it a second glance.

Pankaj and Vipin Lidoo saw opportunity where others saw tedium. India's construction sector was experiencing unprecedented growth, driven by color-coated sheet piling technology. Yet every project hit the same bottleneck: specialized self-drilling screws had to be imported from Taiwan, creating expensive delays and supply vulnerabilities that plagued builders nationwide.

"The entire construction industry was hostage to foreign suppliers for something as basic as a screw," recalls Pankaj Lidoo, now Managing Director of Landmark Crafts. "We realized that India's infrastructure dreams were literally being held together by imported fasteners."

Rather than becoming another middleman in the import chain, the Lidoo brothers embarked on an ambitious journey. Multiple research expeditions to Taiwan, substantial R&D investments, and countless sleepless nights led to establishing India's first indigenous manufacturing facility for self-drilling screws—a bold bet on a product most considered too specialized to matter.

The gamble paid off spectacularly. As India's infrastructure boom accelerated through the 2000s,



► **Pankaj Lidoo**
Managing Director of Landmark Crafts



► **Vipin Lidoo**
Director, Landmark Crafts

Landmark's products became the invisible foundation of the nation's most iconic projects. From Delhi Metro's pioneering construction phases to critical installations by BHEL and Indian Railways, their fasteners quietly held together India's modernization story.

"In every assembled product, there is a fastener holding the structure strong and safe," Pankaj explains. "We provide the strength you may not see, but you can always trust."

Landmark's true innovation lies in understanding India's geographic complexity. In Himachal Pradesh's timber-rich regions, they provide wood-specific solutions. Along Karnataka's coastline, their anti-corrosive variants combat salt-laden air. This localized approach has earned them partnerships across metro systems in multiple cities and infrastructure projects spanning

the subcontinent.

Today, Landmark operates ISO 9001:2015-certified facilities in Panchkula, Haryana, backed by a CRISIL SME-1 rating. Their product portfolio has expanded beyond self-drilling screws to include aluminum blind rivets and drywall screws, with concrete wall screws in development. A network of 10-11 marketing offices ensures nationwide accessibility.

The company's trajectory mirrors India's broader manufacturing evolution—from import dependence to indigenous excellence. Landmark embodied the "Make in India" philosophy decades before it became policy, transforming from Taiwanese screw importers to trusted suppliers for the nation's most critical infrastructure.

"We knew that for India to grow, we had to cut the dependence on imports," Lidoo reflects. "It was not just business for us—it was about contributing to industrial independence."

In an era dominated by unicorn valuations and venture capital headlines, Landmark Crafts represents a different success paradigm—one measured not in market buzz but in structural integrity, not in disruption but in dependability.

Sometimes the smallest components enable the biggest transformations.

